

01. Personal details and the date of the CV

Last name: Nagahawatte

First name: Kaushalya

ORCID: 0009-0001-6763-7159

Date of the CV: 19/5/2026

02. Degrees

- **2024. MSc. in Biological and Environmental Sciences**, University of Jyväskylä, Finland (JYU)

MSc's thesis: Relationship of parasitic *Margaritifera margaritifera* larvae with the host fish Atlantic salmon. Supervisor: Prof. Jouni Taskinen. **Grade 4/5**, <https://urn.fi/URN:NBN:fi:juu-202406174725>

- **2014. BSc. Special in Zoology**, University of Kelaniya, Dalugama, Sri Lanka,

BSc's thesis: Antibacterial activity of rampe, *Pandanus amaryllifollius*, against a pathogenic strain of *Aeromonas hydrophila* and the ability of the plant in maintaining water quality for guppy (*Poecilia reticulata*). Supervisor: Prof. M. Hettiarachchi. **Grade A** (pass with distinction)

03. Other education and expertise aligned with the proposed research project

- **2025. Training workshop in Microbial community / environmental DNA analysis with Chipster**, at CSC – Finnish Center for Informatics in Science, Finland. *Tasks: Sequence pre-processing, quality improvement, microbial community analysis using OUT, PERMANOVA, DESeq2.*
- **2024. Extensive laboratory course in molecular methods**, Department of Biological and Environmental Sciences, JYU, Finland. *Tasks: DNA and RNA isolation, PCR, qPCR assays, metabarcoding, microbial community analysis using CLC workbench, bioinformatics*
- **2024. Internship training in molecular biology tools**, with Prof. Maaria Kankare, Stress Genomics research group, Department of Biological and Environmental Sciences, JYU, Finland. *Tasks: DNA isolation, PCR, agarose gel electrophoresis, Sanger sequencing, sequence analysis using BioEdit software*

04. Language skills

- **Sinhala:** Native language (*mother tongue*)
- **English:** Fluent, work proficiency, *C1 level*
- **Finnish:** Basic, *CEFR level A1*

05. Current employment

- **Since Dec. 2025. Grant-funded researcher**, *Insect Symbiosis Ecology and Evolution research group*, Organismal and Evolutionary Biology Research Program (OEB), University of Helsinki (UH), <https://www.helsinki.fi/en/researchgroups/insect-symbiosis-ecology-and-evolution/group-members>
Supervisors: Dr. Anne Duploux, Dr. Gunilla Ståhl

06. Previous work experience

- **2025-2026. Technical Assistant**, Ecological Data Sciences Group, OEB, hired by Assistant Professor Helen Phillips, <https://www.helsinki.fi/en/researchgroups/ecological-data-sciences>
- **2023. Research Assistant**, LIFE Revives Project, JYU, Finland, <https://www.jyu.fi/science/en/bioenv/research/natural-resources-and-environment/life-revives>
- **2017-2022. High School Biology Teacher**, Sri Dharmaloka National College, Sri Lanka <https://sridharmaloka.lk/>
- **2015-2017. Teaching Assistant**, Department of Zoology and Environmental Sciences, The Open University of Sri Lanka, <https://ou.ac.lk/>
- **2014. Teaching Assistant**, Department of Zoology and Environmental Sciences, University of Kelaniya, Sri Lanka, <https://www.kln.ac.lk/>

Career breaks

- **2017. Maternity leave** (10 months)

Research funding and grants

- **2026. OLVI Foundation personal grant** (10,000€) towards my project 'Investigating the effect of exposure to pesticides on the microbial communities of Finnish hoverflies'

- **2025.** **OLVI Foundation personal grant** (10,000€) towards my project 'Effect of host species & diet on the microbial communities of Finnish hoverflies
- **2023.** **JYU Conference Grant** (€120) for attending the Natural Sciences for Sustainability Conference
- **2022.** **Full tuition scholarship** (€24,000), JYU, MSc program in Biological and Environmental Sciences
- **2022.** **Finnish government scholarship** (€5,000) for the best-selected candidate in the MSc program in Biological and Environmental Sciences, JYU
- **2022.** **Full tuition fee grant** (€30,000), UH, MSc program in Ecology and Evolutionary Biology (Declined)

Research output

Manuscripts under review

- **Nagahawatte, K.R.** and Kulasena Fernando, V. 2026. Influence of urbanization and vegetation structure on Butterfly diversity in two wetlands in Colombo, Sri Lanka, *Journal of the National Science Foundation of Sri Lanka*

Preprint

- **Nagahawatte, K.**, Cooper, N., Allen, B. J., Almaani, N. *et al.* 2026. Data and code archiving in the British Ecological Society journals: present status and recommendations for future improvements. Preprint. <https://doi.org/10.32942/X26W9V>

Preregistrations

- Vanadzina, K., **Nagahawatte, K.**, Gérard, S., Cameron, E. K., Brown, G., Reynolds, J. W., Rice, A., & Phillips, H. R. P. (2025, Nov 6). Systematic evidence map of research on life-history traits in native and introduced earthworms: Preregistration. The Open Science Framework (OSF). <https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/H72ZV>.

Oral presentations

- **2024.** **Invited speaker** for the Insect Symbiosis Ecology and Evolution group seminar. Title presentation: Relationship of parasitic *Margaritifera margaritifera* larvae with the host fish Atlantic salmon
- **2014.** **Nagahawatte, K.R.** and Hettiarachchi, M. Ability of rampe (*Pandanus amaryllifolius*) in maintaining water quality for rearing guppy (*Poecilia reticulata*). The 34th Annual Sessions of the Institute of Biology, Sri Lanka

Teaching merits

- **2026.** Supervision of a bachelor's student in the course "BIO-009 Ecology and Evolutionary Biology research group internship 2026
- **2017- 2022.** Biology curriculum for high school students, for the national university entrance examination in Sri Lanka. My role: teaching, the curriculum included teaching in animal and plant diversity, evolutionary biology, molecular biology and recombination technology, genetics, microbiology, and environmental biology (30 hours per week)
- **2016-2017.** Teaching in the laboratory course in entomology, BSc level course, Department of Zoology and Environmental Management, The Open University, Nawala, Sri Lanka (35 hours per week)
- **2015.** Teaching in the laboratory course in animal form and function, BSc level course, Department of Zoology and Environmental Management, The Open University, Nawala, Sri Lanka (35 hours per week)
- **2014.** Teaching in the laboratory course in evolutionary biology and biogeography, BSc level course, Department of Zoology and Environmental Management, University of Kelaniya, Dalugama, Sri Lanka (10 hours)
- **2014.** Teaching in the laboratory course in terrestrial and aquatic ecology, BSc level course, Department of Zoology and Environmental Management, University of Kelaniya, Dalugama, Sri Lanka (40 hours)

Other merits

- **2025.** **Outreach organizer and speaker: OEB goes Vappushokkelo** (1st May), activity on the theme "co-evolution of insects and birds", UH
- **2025-.** Member of The Entomological Society of Finland, Finland
- **2024.** Participant in the Civic Orientation Course for Integration into Finnish Society. Jyväskylä Education Consortium Gradia
- **2024.** **Writer**, Student stories, <https://www.jyu.fi/en/story/jyu-opened-doors-for-my-dream-after-several-gap-years-of-my-education-journey>
- **2023.** **Volunteer**, Researcher's Night, Department of Biology and Environmental Sciences, University of Jyväskylä

- **2018-2022. Supervisor**, School Solid Waste Management Project, Sri Dharmaloka College, Sri Lanka
Role: Providing leadership, coordinating the project with stakeholders, and raising Community awareness
- **2014–2016. Volunteer**, Butterfly Conservation Society, Sri Lanka
- **2014. Organizer**, International Symposium on ICT for Environmental Sustainability, University of Kelaniya, Sri Lanka